



4.3 - First Steps in OWL



Knowledge Graphs

Lecture 4: Knowledge Representation with Ontologies

4.1 A Brief History of Ontologies

4.2 Why we do need Logic

Excursion 4: A Brief Recap of Essential Logics

Excursion 5: Description Logics

4.3 First Steps in OWL

4.4 More OWL

4.5 OWL and beyond

4.6 How to Design your own Ontology

The Semantic Web Technology Stack (not a piece of cake...)

Most apps use only a subset of the stack

Querying allows fine-grained data access

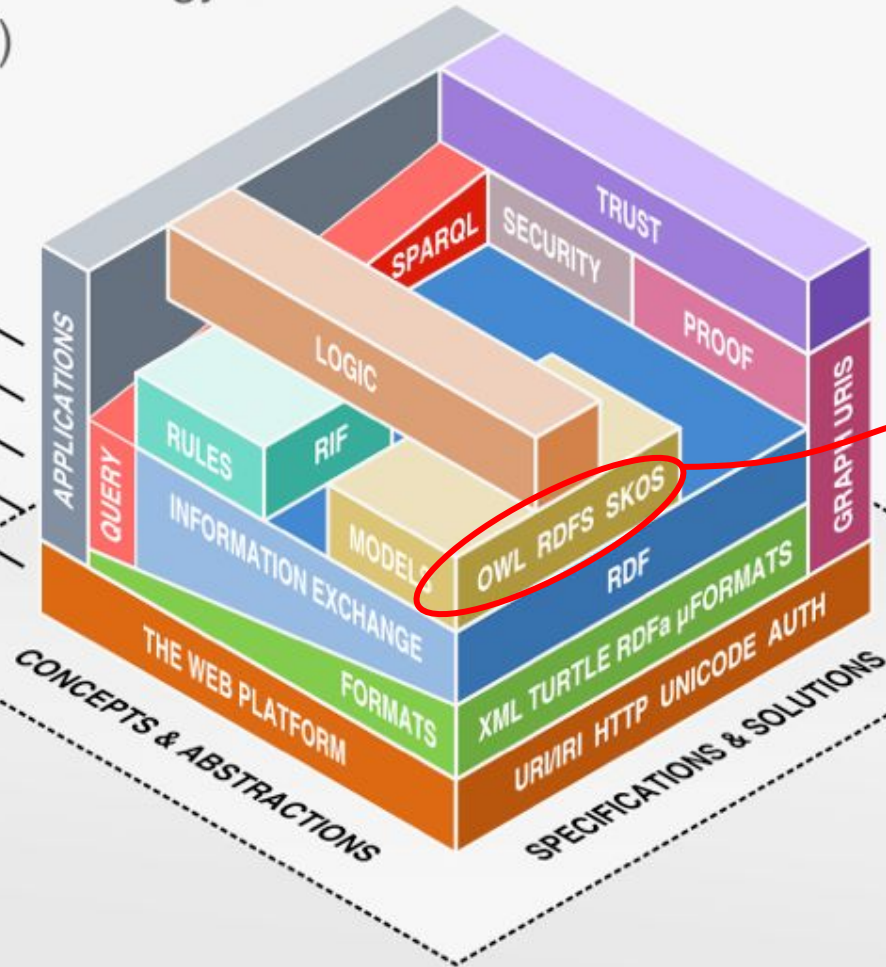
Standardized information exchange is key

Formats are necessary, but not too important

The Semantic Web is based on the Web

Linked Data uses a small
selection of technologies

LINKED DATA



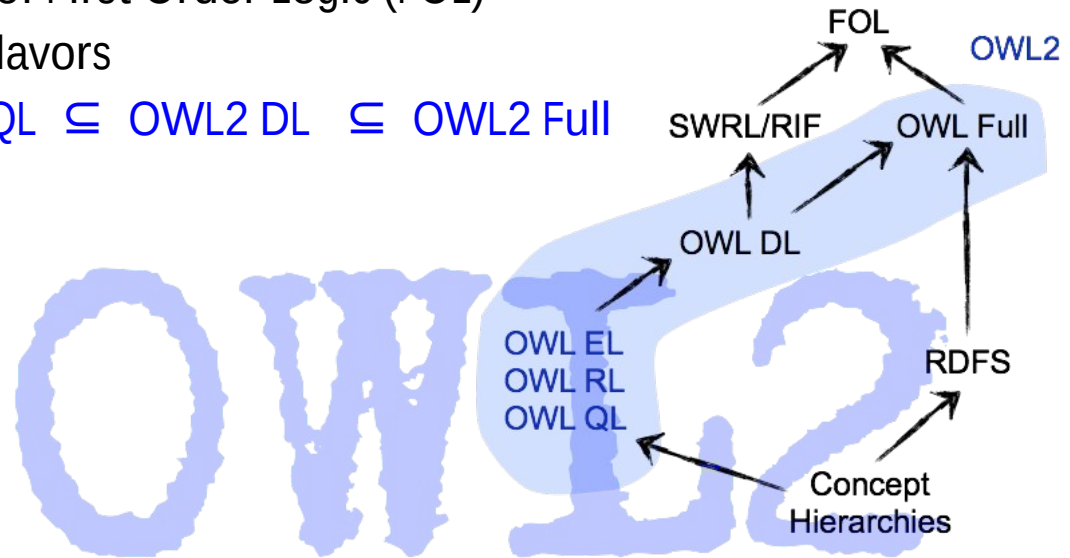
Web
Ontology
Language
(OWL)

Web Ontology Language OWL - OWL Flavours

OWL is a semantic fragment of First Order Logic (FOL)

OWL also exists in different flavors

- OWL EL, OWL RL, OWL QL $\subseteq$ OWL2 DL $\subseteq$ OWL2 Full



OWL2 is based on the Description Logic $\mathcal{SROIQ}(\mathcal{D})$

Class Expressions

Class names A, B

Conjunction $C \sqcap D$

Disjunction $C \sqcup D$

Negation $\neg C$

Exist. property restriction $\exists R.C$

Univ. property restriction $\forall R.C$

Self $\exists S.\text{Self}$

Greater-than $\geq n S.C$

Less-than $\leq n S.C$

Enumerated classes $\{a\}$

Properties

Property names R, S, T

Simple properties S, T

Inverse properties R^{-}

Universal property U

Tbox (Class axioms)

Inclusion $C \sqsubseteq D$

Equivalence $C \equiv D$

Rbox (Property Axioms)

Inclusion $R_1 \sqsubseteq R_2$

General Inclusion $R^{(-)}_1 \circ R^{(-)}_2 \circ \dots \circ R^{(-)}_n \sqsubseteq R$

Transitivity

Symmetry

Reflexivity

Irreflexivity

Disjointness

Abox (Facts)

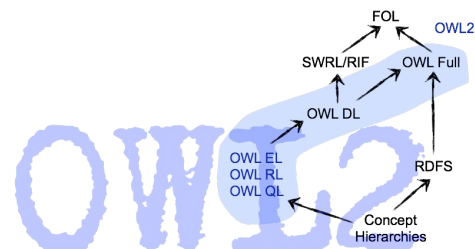
Class membership $C(a)$

Property relation $R(a, b)$

Negated property relation $\neg S(a, b)$

Equality $a=b$

Inequality $a \neq b$



OWL Basic Building Blocks

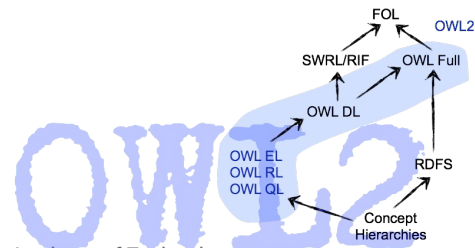
OWL namespace:

@prefix owl: <<http://www.w3.org/2002/07/owl#>>

There is a Turtle Syntax for OWL

OWL axioms consist of the following three building blocks:

- Classes
comparable with classes in RDFS
- Individuals
comparable with class instances in RDFS
- Properties
comparable with properties in RDFS



OWL Classes

There exist two predefined classes

`owl:Thing` (class that contains all individuals)

`owl:Nothing` (empty class)

equivalent expression in
description logics

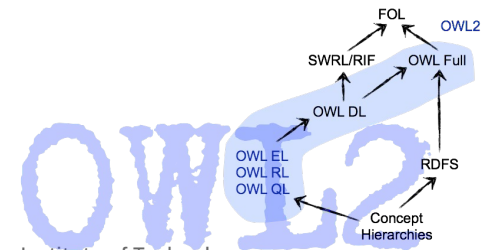
$\top$ $C \sqcup \neg C$

$\perp$ $C \sqcap \neg C$

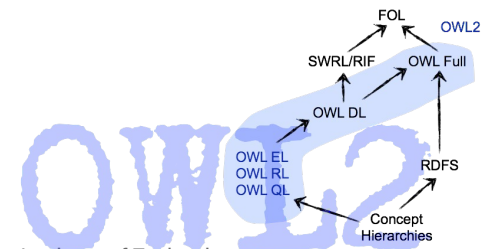
- Definition of a class

```
:GreenhouseGas a owl:Class .
```

This is OWL in RDF/Turtle serialization



OWL Individuals



OWL Datatype Properties

Datatype properties have datatypes as range

:discoveredIn a `owl:DatatypeProperty` .

Domain and Range of datatype properties

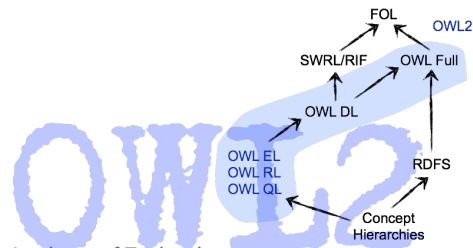
:discoveredIn a `owl:DatatypeProperty` ;

`rdfs:domain owl:Thing` ;

`rdfs:range xsd:date` .

$\exists \text{discoveredIn} . \top \sqsubseteq \top$

$\top \sqsubseteq \forall \text{discoveredIn} . \text{Date}$



OWL Properties and Individuals

OWL TBox

```

:AtmosphericProcess a owl:Class .
:Person a owl:Class .

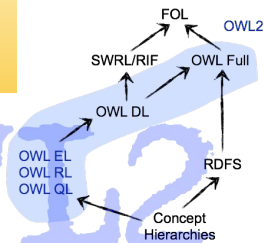
:discoverer a owl:ObjectProperty ;
    rdfs:domain owl:Thing ;
    rdfs:range :Person .

:discoveredIn a owl:DatatypeProperty ;
    rdfs:domain owl:Thing ;
    rdfs:range xsd:date .
  
```

```

:JosephFourier a Person .
:GreenhouseEffect a :AtmosphericProcess ;
    :discoverer :JosephFourier ;
    :discovered "1824-00-00"^^xsd:date .
  
```

OWL ABox



OWL Class Hierarchies

```
:Physicist a owl:Class ;  
    rdfs:subClassOf :Scientist .  
:Scientist a owl:Class ;  
    rdfs:subClassOf :Person .  
:Person a owl:Class .
```

we don't need to define a new
subClassOf property for owl, we
simply reuse rdfs:subClassOf

Physicist $\sqsubseteq$ Scientist
Scientist $\sqsubseteq$ Person

via inference it can be entailed that :Physicist is also a subclass of :Person

OWL Class Hierarchies and Disjunctiveness

```
:ChemicalSubstance a owl:Class .  
:Person a owl:Class .  
:GreenhouseGas a owl:Class ;  
    rdfs:subClassOf :ChemicalSubstance .  
:Scientist a owl:Class ;  
    rdfs:subClassOf :Person .  
  
:ChemicalSubstance owl:disjointWith :Person .
```

In OWL everything might be potentially identical if we don't explicitly state the difference

GreenhouseGas $\sqsubseteq$ ChemicalSubstance
Scientist $\sqsubseteq$ Person
ChemicalSubstance $\sqcap$ Person $\sqsubseteq \perp$

via inference it can be entailed that :GreenhouseGas and :Scientist are also disjoint classes

OWL Class Hierarchies and Equivalence

```
:Scientist a owl:Class .  
:Researcher a owl:Class .  
:Physicist a owl:Class ;  
    rdfs:subClassOf :Scientist .  
  
:Scientist owl:equivalentClass :Researcher .
```

Physicist $\sqsubseteq$ Scientist
Scientist $\equiv$ Researcher

via inference it can be entailed that :Physicist is also a :Researcher

OWL Individuals - Identity and Distinctiveness

```
:CarbonDioxide a :GreenhouseGas ;  
  :discoverer :JosephBlack ;  
  :discoveredIn "1750-00-00"^^xsd:date ;  
  owl:sameAs :ARX012345 .  
  
:GreenhouseGas a owl:Class ;  
  rdfs:subClassOf :ChemicalSubstance .  
  
:ChemicalSubstance a owl:Class.
```

For identical individuals: owl:sameAs

For identical classes: owl:equivalentClass

via inference it can be entailed that :ARX012345 is a :ChemicalSubstance
difference of Individuals via owl:differentFrom

```
:ARX012345 a :GreenhouseGas ;  
  owl:differentFrom :ARX012346 .
```



More OWL

Next Lecture...

Picture References:

- [1] Benjamin Nowack, *The Semantic Web - Not a Piece of cake...*, at bnode.org, 2009-07-08 , [CC BY 3.0]
<http://bnode.org/blog/2009/07/08/the-semantic-web-not-a-piece-of-cake>
- [2] Gustave Doré, Two Owls, 19th century [Public Domain]
<https://www.wikiart.org/en/gustave-dore/two-owls>